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In the war of the slimmest, Sony has emerged as the winner with the world's slimmest TV measuring less than a centimetre

■ SRABANI SEN

It's a war of the slimmest. After years of developing TV sets with bigger screens, the TV industry diverted its focus on the thickness of sets and several brands, including Sony, Panasonic, LG, JVC, Hitachi and Sharp, have recently hit the market with TV sets that measure less than 3 cm in thickness.

With an aim to capture the market, brands are trying to widen the gap with their nearest competitors in the liquid crystal display (LCD) and light-emitting diode (LED) markets. Sony India launched its latest range of 14 new Bravia models in India, which claims to be the world's slimmest and world's only motionflow 200Hz. Panasonic, too, hit the market with its 'razor slim' LED TV.

"Bravia is a brand with its eyes firmly on the future," says Masaru Tamagawa, managing director, Sony India. "Bravia ZX1 is the world's slimmest LCD TV measuring 9.9 mm against 29.9 mm of that of our competitors and

weighs about 15 kg," points out Tamagawa.

Panasonic's newest model measures 3 cm with built-in TV tuner. It claims to have mega clarity with true-to-life full high-definition (HD) images and being eco-friendly, saves 40 per cent power. It also claims to be mercury- and lead-free.

LG had previously announced world's slimmest LED LCD TV, measuring 2.5 cm thick and supporting 240Hz true-motion drive technology and 2,000,000:1 contrast ratio with LH95.

Meanwhile, JVC missed out on its promise for a super-skinny 81cm LED-backlit full HD TV model measuring 7 mm thick—although it has nabbed the 'lightest' position with its new model weighing just 5 kg and measuring 3.8 cm thick across most of the back of the panel, which is significantly thinner than most flat-panel TVs.

At least for the time being, Sony has emerged as the winner in the war of the slimmest with less-than-a-centimetre thick TV set. It managed to thin

down by using the edge LED technology. The LCD panel is illuminated with Bravia edge LED technology, which dramatically reduces the weight and the depth of LCD TVs.

The world's slimmest Sony TV model ZX1 uses latest technologies like motionflow 200Hz, full-HD display resolution of 1920×1080 pixels and Bravia engine 3, making images clearer and vibrant. "We are not only focusing on being the slimmest but also on performance and enhanced display performance significantly. We are also attaining the ultimate feel experience for our consumers. What you see and hear is what you experience via Bravia," adds Tamagawa.

Apart from the usual Bravia features like live colour creation, 24p cinema, Xross media bar and Bravia theatre sync, Bravia ZX1 has audio enhancement features like digital amplifier, S-force surround, voice zoom, Dolby digital plus, etc. The screen has two integrated speakers and a woofer that deliver a net output power of 20 watts.

ZX1 also has wireless HD that enables the users to enjoy full-HD-quality images without any messy wire or cable. Wireless technology enables the user to utilise the media library located anywhere in the house, via supplied HD media receiver. The ZX1 series will be put on the market by the third week of June with an estimated price tag of Rs 16,000 for 48cm set to Rs 200,000 for a 117cm set.

Sony may not bask in the glory of this super-skinny TV for long as soon its competitors are expected to bring out even thinner TVs. ●



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